Media Advisory for Tuesday, May 29, 2024, 9AM
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County Workers and Community Members Pack Supervisor Budget Hearings to Demand Support for Public Services

Monterey County union workers are uniting to advocate for sustained investment in quality public service union jobs, public assistance benefits, and working families.

Salinas, CA – On Wednesday, May 29th at 9 AM, SEIU 521 represented county workers will pack the Monterey County Board of Supervisors chambers at 168 W. Alisal Street, Salinas, CA during budget hearings, to outline the impacts of proposed cuts to public programs that would further strain services and deepen the County's recruitment and retention challenges. Despite a drastic increase to unsafe working conditions and a workforce debilitated by the ongoing vacancy crisis, SEIU 521 is spearheading the push for Monterey County to adopt a budget that will invest in public services. *Key topics county workers are advocating for include:*

- Investment in public benefit programs like California Welfare Information Network (CALwin), Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (CalFresh/SNAP), and Medicaid.
- Investment in County agencies struggling under the weight of a widespread vacancy crisis.
- Testimonies from county workers and community supporters focusing on the need for equitable distribution of public services funding.
- Preserve community lifelines and good union jobs that support local economies.

> *"State and County officials must invest in shared public services to ensure our local economy and good union jobs. At the same time, officials must sustain benefits for children, and seniors, water treatment, roadwork, and tax collection services that we collectively benefit and fund. The ripple effects of cutting public services will be felt for generations. From Salinas to Sacramento our community deserves better."*
> *–Yvette Carreon**, SEIU 521 Member and Behavioral Health Unit Supervisor***

WHAT: County Workers and Community Members Swell Board of Supervisors Chambers
WHEN: Tuesday, May 29, 2024 9 AM
WHERE: 168 W. Alisal Street, Salinas, CA 93901
WHO: SEIU 521 Monterey County union workers and Monterey County residents
WHY: Essential county workers are speaking out en masse to urge the Board of Supervisors to take bold action by investing in public services, countering plans for deep budget cuts.
VISUALS: *SEIU 521 county workers and community members dressed in purple and yellow, "Invest in public services!" Signs and posters, a swelling attendance of vocal opponents.*

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Service Employees International Union, Local 521 represents 53,000 public- and nonprofit, private-sector workers in California's Bay Area, the Central Coast, and in the Central Valley. Under a Community First vision, we are committed to making sure the needs of our community, and the vital services we provide

our community, come first. We believe our communities thrive when residents, leaders and workers recognize that we are all in this together when it comes to our safety, health, and well-being.